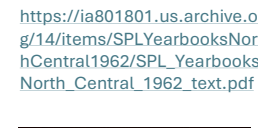
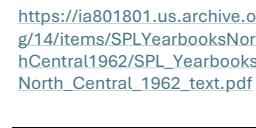
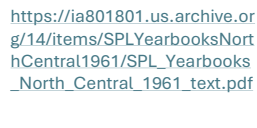
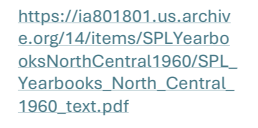
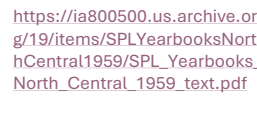
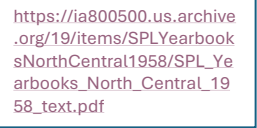


North Central High School Tamarack Yearbooks and Teachers of the Class of 1976

Bill Worstell

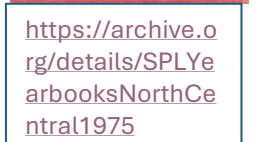
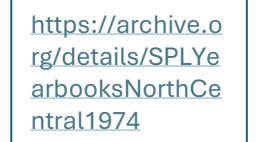
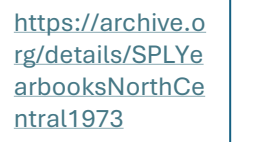
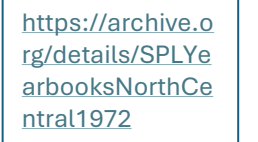
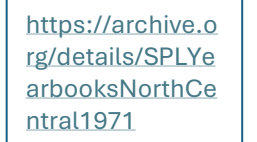
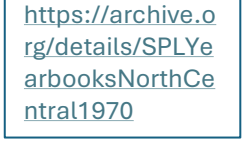
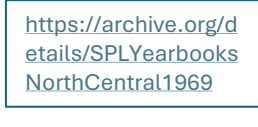
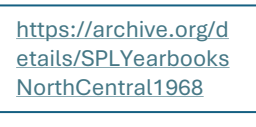
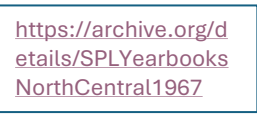
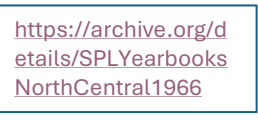
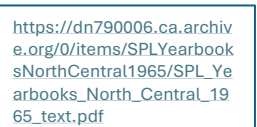
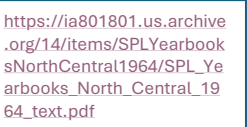
5/31/2026



tamarack

A stylized illustration on a dark blue background. On the left, a man and a woman are walking towards the viewer. The man is wearing a long-sleeved shirt with a dark collar and a wide belt, and patterned trousers. The woman is wearing a light-colored, short-sleeved top and wide-leg trousers, carrying a shoulder bag. Above them is a rotary telephone. To the right is a guitar with a long, braided neck. Below the guitar is a car with a skull on the front and flames on the side. At the bottom right is a rocket with a star on its side, flying over a cloud. The entire illustration is framed by a dark border.

1976



Which of our teachers had a half dozen of our other teachers as teachers when he graduated from NC in 1957?

Weir, Michael Charles

Social Studies

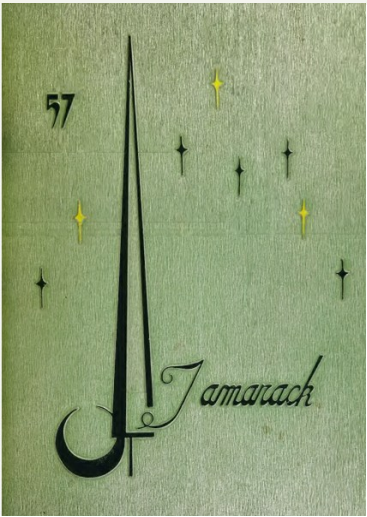
Transferred from Gonzaga. Varsity
Track, Baseball, Football



Mr. Theisen- Physics



Mr. Simonson - Biology



Mrs. Briscoe - Latin



Mr. Exley - Geometry



Mr. Nye- Algebra



Mr. Erickson –
General Math

For 2 of coach Weir’s 6 teachers, 1957 was their first year. Can you guess which two?



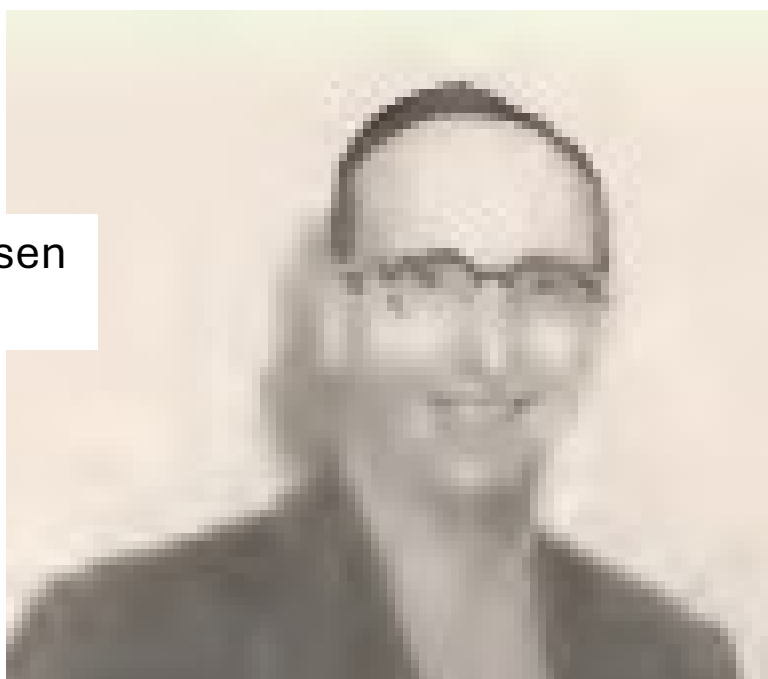
Mr. Nye
Algebra



Mr. Exley
Geometry



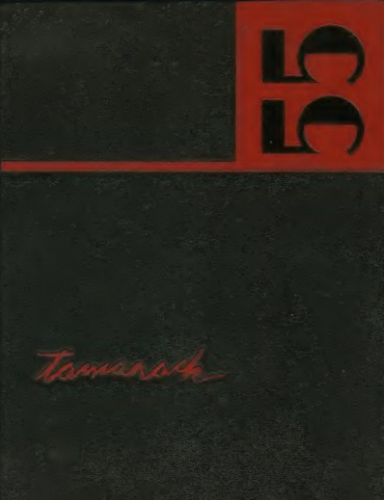
Mr. Theisen
Physics



Mr. Simonson
Biology



It's the 1956 Tamarack, and we're down to just 4 semi-finalists to see who, before we were all born, was the first of our teachers to start teaching at NC – all in the Math/Science Old Boy's Club!



Mr. Exley -Math



1955 Tamarack

of our civilization's great unchanging secrets.

Mathematics ranges in difficulty from elementary arithmetic, studied in some freshman classes, to subjects on the college level. Although only one year of mathematics is required for graduation, many sophomores elect Plane Geometry. This year about one hundred twenty juniors are enrolled in Advanced Algebra, and more than fifty seniors are taking a fourth year of mathematics consisting mainly of Solid Geometry and Trigonometry.

Most students are aware that the completion of two years of high school mathematics is required for entrance to many colleges. Boys, especially, are faced with the

fact that every reputable engineering school in the country has a prerequisite of at least three years of mathematics and that nearly all of these schools recommend four years. To prepare themselves properly in this age of mechanization and electrification, intelligent students know that mathematics is indispensable.

Recent developments in the field of automatic computers demand many more college trained mathematicians than are available. Each large machine of this type requires at least ten or fifteen analytical experts to program its operations and to control its sequences.

It's the 1955 Tamarack, and we're down to just 3 semi-finalists to see who, before we were all born, was the first of our teachers to start teaching at NC !



SCIENCE DEPARTMENT — Seated: Wilhelmine Timm, Biology; Raymond Simonsen, Biology; Donald Bonamy, Biology. Standing: Ernest Hix, Department Head; Paul Tobie, Biology; Edward Anderson, General Science; Orval Theisen, Physics; George Smith, Biology.

Over eleven hundred students are enrolled each semester in the various science courses. These students are in the six sciences: General Science, Biology, Chemistry, Physics, Photography and Geology.

Through General Science, students gain an introduction to all fields of science. Then comes Biology, the study of living things. The biology laboratory is well equipped with movies and specimens to enable the student to learn about the human body, plants and animals.

Chemistry is the study of what things are composed of and the changes they undergo. Such things as atomic energy,

radio activity, and the composition of foods and fabrics are taught.

Dealing with electricity, sound, light, heat, mechanics and other physical aspects of our complicated world is the course in Physics. Both the chemistry and physics laboratories are well equipped for experiments and demonstrations.

Photography offers the knowledge of how to take pictures, how to operate picture-taking devices, how to take better pictures, and how to develop, print and enlarge them. Geology offers the study of rocks, minerals, changes in the earth and earth composition.

Mr. Theisen -Physics



Mr. Samuelson- Biology





1954 Tamarack

It's the 1954 Tamarack, and we're down to just 2 finalists to see who, before we were all born, was the first of our teachers to start teaching at NC – both in the Math/Science Old Boy's Club! But wait, someone has brought in a ringer!

John Rodkey
Social Studies
Senior Class Adviser



Burrill Exley
Mathematics
Assistant Varsity
Track Coach



Raymond Simonson
Science
Detention Room





It's the 1953 Tamarack, and ladies and gentlemen, we have a winner!

Mr. Exley was the first of our teachers to have taught at NC! And it's not even close – except for Mr. Rodkey, who is a special case, with a gap in his tenure.

He had in fact been teaching there for more than 25 years, since 1950. We have photographic evidence that he did not age a day his first 3 years.



1953 – age 30

Mr. Exley -

Burrill Dean Exley (1923–1997) was a beloved math teacher, coach, and department head at North Central High School in Spokane from 1950 to 1978.

Biographical Highlights:

•Early Life &

Service: Born in Colville, Washington, he was a veteran of World War II.

•**Career:** He taught algebra and geometry at North Central High School for 28 years. Afterward, he taught at Kennedy High School in Burien, Washington, from 1980 to 1985.

1953 Tamarack

Mr. Rodkey did not age for 2 years.

1949 – age 28

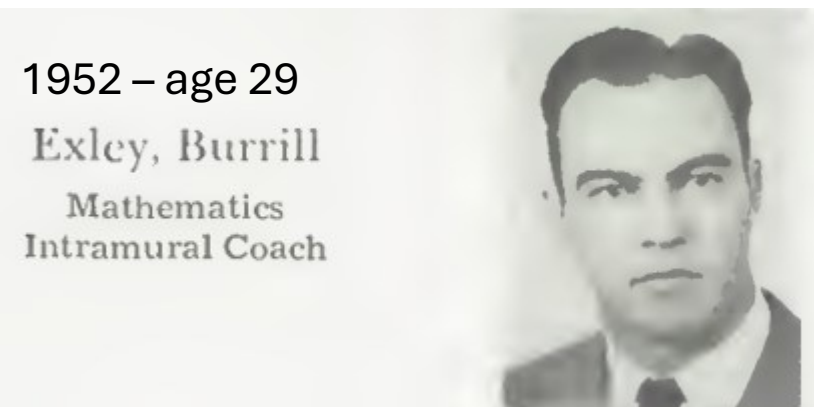
1949 Tamarack

JOHN RODKEY
English
Mathematics
Social Studies
Frosh Athletics



1952 Tamarack

1951 Tamarack



1952 – age 29
Exley, Burrill
Mathematics
Intramural Coach



1950 Tamarack

John Rodkey
Social Studies
Whitworth College, B.A., B.Ed.



1958
Tamarack

William Nye, algebra
P. H. Nygaard, mathematics
department head
Mack L. Saunders, geometry
Robert F. Barnard, algebra



Dorothy Congdon, geometry
Burrill Exley, algebra
Raymond Simonson, biology
Paul Tobie, biology



Mathematics
Science

The mathematics department has added an analysis course for second semester seniors to better prepare them for college mathematics. Students may become thoroughly versed in quantitative fundamentals by enrolling in courses in algebra, geometry, trigonometry and analysis. Courses offered by the science department are necessary for students planning for college or for a career in fields such as medicine, engineering or nursing.

Mary York, bookkeeping
Norman W. Erickson, typing
Mary Griggs, stenography
James Griggs, department head



Edward E. Feldhusen, typing
A. A. Manfred, typing
Helen Stockdale, typing
Blair Glover, stenography



Business Education

The business education department offers two years each of book-keeping, stenography and typing, and one year of office practice. Students should specialize either in bookkeeping or stenography to be prepared for office positions offered to high school graduates. It is wise to schedule as many commercial subjects as possible during the last semesters of high school so that one's skills will be fresh when he enters the business world.



Orval Theisen, physics
Walter Spangenburg, biology
Donald Bonamy, biology
Ernest Hix, science department head



Dale E. Blair, biology
Laura Lee Briscoe, Latin
Helen Oscarson, foreign language
department head
Robert Rowley, Spanish

Science
Foreign Languages

General science and biology courses offered by the science department provide a background for advanced studies. Physics and chemistry give an understanding of the properties and behavior of matter and prepare students for college work. Studying the culture of other nations to increase understanding, tolerance and appreciation of other people is part of the Spanish and Latin courses.

1959
Tamarack

Over the door of his famous academy in Athens, Plato placed the inscription: "Let no one destitute of geometry enter."
One of the chief characteristics of the present time is that the human mind is asserting itself largely through the power of mathematics. Colleges are emulating Plato by raising the mathematical requirements in nearly all departments of instruction. Students of mathematics in our schools should now be more vigorously "disposed to learn" than ever before.

MATHEMATICS



Top row: P. H. Nygaard, department head; Robert F. Barnard, algebra; Dorothy Congdon, geometry. Bottom row: Gurrit Estey, algebra; Edwin Kreitz, algebra; William Nysc, algebra; Mack L. Saunders, algebra.



Top row: Ernest Hix, department head; Dale E. Bate, biology; William C. Lowther, biology; Raymond Simonson, chemistry. Bottom row: Walter Spangenburg, biology; Arval Theisen, physics; Paul Tobie, geology.

SCIENCE

An ever-changing world challenges both the student and the teacher. The science department introduces a basis for study; students then have the opportunity to choose the scientific phases which interest them most.
In the biology courses, students learn the science of living things. Physics brings forth an interest in the forces which challenge the minds of modern society. Learning the wonders of chemical composition thrills chemistry students. A study of rocks and minerals is introduced through geology.

Offering two years each in typing, shorthand and bookkeeping and one year of office practice, the business education department prepares graduates for office positions. Valuable personal-use information may also be obtained.
For vocational use, the student should plan a schedule to include four semesters in either bookkeeping or shorthand. Enrolling in these subjects during the last semesters of school will mean that the skills will be usable when the student enters the business world.



BUSINESS
EDUCATION



Top row: James Griggs, department head; Norman W. Erickson, typing; Edward E. Feldhusen, typing. Bottom row: Blair Glover, bookkeeping; Mary Griggs, shorthand; A. A. Manfred, typing; Helen Stockdale, typing; Mary York, bookkeeping.

Students of the fine arts department explore specialized phases such as fashion design and oil painting after learning the basic principles of design and colors.
In the foreign language department students learn about a people through their language. Essential to this modern civilization is a knowledge of other lands.
The music department attempts to give students an understanding and appreciation of all types of music. This understanding provides an enduring basis of enjoyment and pleasure through a broader understanding of modern culture.

FINE ARTS
FOREIGN LANGUAGES
MUSIC



Top row: Kenneth Myhre, art department head; Mervin Manuel, art; Helen Oscarson, language department head. Bottom row: Laura Lee Briscoe, Latin; Stanley Taft, music department head; Lowell C. Bradford, band director.

1960
Tamarack



Principal John P. Rodkey

Now that it has ended . . .

The end of the year has come at last! With it have come the joys of anticipation for a summer of fun! Also has come the feeling of something worthwhile accomplished . . . or a feeling of something left undone.

To you who are leaving our family circle, we send our best wishes for many years of happiness as you assume the responsibilities of greater tasks, whether they be college, vocational training, employment, or family. It was pleasant to have known you these short years. Your absence will be keenly felt.

To you who remain, we anticipate your conscientious effort based upon a realization of the good things your community and your school desire for you.

Before we forget the accomplishments or frustrations of the past year, perhaps we should look again at the goals we have set for the future, goals which demand planning and preparation, that require our best effort, and goals that may change with new interests gained from experiences and learning. One of the basic facts of growth is this: THERE IS NO PROGRESS WITHOUT EVALUATION.

We express our deepest thanks for your co-operation and spirit during 1959-1960. You are proving that you are equal to the task of responsibility so vital to our country's need. May your summer be most enjoyable, and may it awaken in you new challenges for the future!

John P. Rodkey

Lower right: Orvol Theisen,
is demonstrating centrifugal force with the Hula Hoop.



1960 Tamarack



Top row: P. H. Nygaard, department head; Robert Barnes, algebra; Donatt Congdon, geometry; **Harold Taylor, algebra**; Edwin Kretz, algebra; Bottom row: William Lowther, algebra; **William Newcomb, algebra**; Mack Saunders, algebra.



MATHEMATICS

"The science of pure mathematics, in its modern developments, may claim to be the most original creation of the human spirit." —A. N. Whitehead

Colleges and universities are placing more emphasis on mathematics by raising their standards of requirement in nearly all fields of education. In addition to required freshman mathematics, higher courses such as geometry 1 and 2, algebra 3 and 4, and trigonometry and analysis for seniors are offered.

In preparation for careers in the business world, the business education department offers two-year courses in stenography, bookkeeping, and typing, and a one-year course in office practice. Not only are these courses helpful in laying a foundation for a career in business, but they also provide useful information for all walks of life.

It is important that students arrange enrollment in business education courses in the latter semesters of their school years so that they will not lose any of the skills acquired in these subjects.

BUSINESS EDUCATION

Top row: James Griggs, department head; **Norman Erickson, typing**; Bottom row: **Sam Griggs, stenography**; J. A. Manfred, typing; Helen Stockdale, typing; Mary York, bookkeeping.



Top row: Ernest Hix, department head; Dale E. Blair, biology; **Kaymond Sammons, biology**; Walter Scott, biology; **Carol Hansen, physics**; Bottom row: Paul Reute, geology; Madeline Carroll, head librarian; Lillian Barnes, assistant librarian.

SCIENCE



Both student and teacher are challenged by the rapid advance the world has taken and is taking in science.

One year of laboratory science above the ninth grade is required for high school graduation. General science is a special course for freshmen only. Biology, chemistry, physics, geology and photography are the other science courses.

Madeline Carroll, librarian, and Lillian Barnes, assistant, are vital to the students at North Central. Many students use the library every day for reports. Miss Carroll and Mrs. Barnes give appreciated help to numerous students.

The aim of the foreign language courses is the development of the ability to understand, speak, read, and write the language studied.

In the past few years, North Central students have shown a rapidly increasing interest in foreign languages, especially the modern languages. This is shown by the addition of French to Latin and Spanish, which were already offered. A thriving extra-curricular class in Russian is another indication that modern languages are gaining in popularity. Beginning German may be offered next fall if there is enough demand.

FOREIGN LANGUAGES



Top row: Helen Gusterson, department head, Latin; **Louise Lee Briscoe, Latin**; Bottom row: **Carol Newett, Latin**; Genevieve Oppen, Spanish; Joseph C. Tremblay, French.



1961
Tamarack



Principal John P. Rodkey

Principal John P. Rodkey Bears Many Responsibilities

John P. Rodkey, as principal of North Central, assumes many responsibilities. Before he comes to school, he makes arrangements for substitute teachers. After arriving at school, he consults with teachers about grading and other problems.

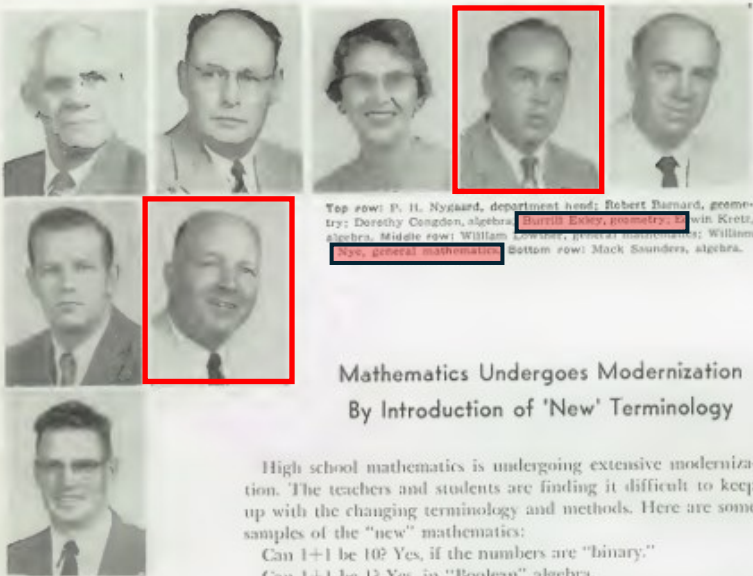
In the morning, Mr. Rodkey works with the deans and vice-principal on acute discipline cases and has orientation with cadet teachers assigned by the nearby teacher-training colleges. Lunch, if any at all, is usually taken shortly after noon.

In the afternoon, Mr. Rodkey attends meetings with other secondary principals of the school district and with the athletic board of control to discuss league schedules and problems. Every

Tuesday after school he conducts a faculty meeting for the in-service training of teachers. Mr. Rodkey also edits the daily bulletin of school news and when completing this, he often has a meeting at the Administration building to work on millage and bond levies or other school matters with the board and superintendent.

During his busy day, Mr. Rodkey answers numerous phone calls, writes volumes of correspondence regarding former students, discusses curriculum problems with department heads and makes plans for building improvements. In the evenings, he attends the athletic, music and drama events of the school and helps chaperone the school dances.

1961 Tamarack

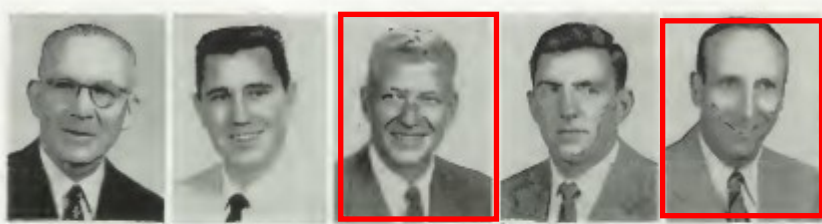


**Mathematics Undergoes Modernization
By Introduction of 'New' Terminology**

High school mathematics is undergoing extensive modernization. The teachers and students are finding it difficult to keep up with the changing terminology and methods. Here are some samples of the "new" mathematics:

Can $1+1$ be 10? Yes, if the numbers are "binary."
 Can $1+1$ be 1? Yes, in "Boolean" algebra.
 Can $7+8$ be 3? Yes, if the "modulus" is twelve.
 When is y a "function" of x ? When there is one, and only one, value of y for every x .
 What is a point? In plane analytical geometry it is an "ordered pair" of numbers.

Top row: P. H. Nygaard, department head; Robert Barnard, geometry; Dorothy Congdon, algebra; **Burt Eddy, geometry**; Edwin Kretz, algebra. **Middle row:** William Kretz, general mathematics; William Nyg, general mathematics. **Bottom row:** Mack Saunders, algebra.



**Will North Central Science Classes
Obtain Energy from Nuclear Fusion?**

Top row: Ernest Hix, department head; Dale E. Blair, biology; Raymond Simmons, biology; Walter Spangenberg, biology; Orval Chelton, physics. **Bottom row:** Paul Tobie, geology.

What lies ahead in science for North Central students? Will a biology class discover the cause of cancer and a way to control it? Will a class in geology succeed in drilling a Mohole through the earth's crust to reach the interior region? Will physics or chemistry students succeed in designing and building a rocket that will put a man in space or find a way to obtain energy from controlled nuclear fission?

Of course none of these things are possible for high school students. But definite progress on all is being made by well-trained scientists.

North Central science classes are giving capable students an opportunity to learn fundamental facts and theories that will give them a good start toward a scientific career that offers almost unlimited possibilities. The classes offer students who are not interested in a scientific career an opportunity to gain some understanding of the constantly changing scientific world in which they live.

Valuable courses in everyday life and in earning a living are offered in the business education department. Typing is a timesaving skill that nearly everyone needs. In addition to its vocational and personal values, the study of bookkeeping makes an individual aware of the problems of the American way of life. Skill in shorthand will open the door of opportunity to many graduates. A knowledge of office machines, filing, business arithmetic, business English and letter writing increases the potential value of a graduate in the business world.

To attain these goals, the business education department offers two-year courses in typing, bookkeeping and shorthand, and a one-year course in office practice. Typing is open to all students; bookkeeping to sophomores, juniors and seniors; shorthand to juniors and seniors, and office practice to seniors only.

If one wishes to be vocationally proficient in typing, shorthand or bookkeeping, it is highly recommended that these subjects be studied for two years. For personal use, one year is usually sufficient, and will fulfill any necessary experience after graduation.



**Business Education Department Offers
Valuable Courses in Everyday Life**

Top row: James Griggs, department head; **Norman Erickson, typing**; Blair Glover, shorthand; A. A. Manfred, typing; Helen Stockdale, typing. **Bottom row:** Mary York, bookkeeping.



**Growing Interest in Languages Results
In New Classes, German and Latin 5 and 6**

Top row: Helen Ocarson, department head; **Laura Lee Briscoe, Latin**; Larry Lockett, Spanish; Carol Neuhoff, German; Genevieve Oppen, Spanish. **Bottom row:** Joseph Tremblay, French.

Rapidly increasing interest in foreign languages has been shown by North Central students during the past few years. This interest was increased to the point where two new classes were added to the department's curriculum. Latin 5 and 6 and German 1 and 2 were offered this year in addition to the Spanish, French and Latin 1-4 classes. A second year of German will be offered next year.

A basic foundation for other languages can be attained by taking Latin. Latin also serves as a classical background. The third-year Latin students are concentrating on reading, especially that of Cicero.

In the three modern languages offered, Spanish, French and German, an earnest effort is made to teach the student to speak the language, as well as to read and write it. In his study of the language, the student also learns much about the people of the country—their customs, their history, their literature, their way of thinking.

1964
Tamarack



Burrill Exley
Advanced Math
Math Club



Raymond Simonson
Biology
Boys' Golf



William Nye
Algebra
Boys' Intramurals



Mr. Rodkey, Principal,



Orval Theisen
Physics
Junior Homeroom
Chairman



Laura Briscoe
Latin
Latin Club



Norman Erickson
Bookkeeping
ASB Faculty
Committee

